



FY 2027 Administrative Lead Entity Functions RFQ Official Questions and Answers

The Los Angeles Continuum of Care (LA CoC) received the following questions in response to the Request for Qualifications (RFQ) and is providing the following written answers. Note for efficiency this document consolidates RFQ-related questions, where reasonable, that were received through the published written questions process before the deadline of 11:59 pm PST on September 17, 2026. Questions have been anonymized and stripped of signatures, advocacy, background narratives, and other material not necessary to address the RFQ issue.

1. Will the LA CoC disclose the names of entities that submitted a Mandatory Intent to Apply or a Full Application, including the roles sought?

Answer: No. To protect the integrity of the open procurement and selection process, the LA CoC will not disclose through the RFQ Q&A process the identities of entities that submitted a Mandatory Intent to Apply or a Full Application, or the roles sought. Information will be released only as required by applicable law, court order, or subsequent official action of the LA CoC's governing bodies.

2. What was the deadline for submitting the Mandatory Intent to Apply?

Answer: The Mandatory Intent to Apply was due by email to rfq@losangelescoc.org on Tuesday, September 15, 2026, by 5:00 p.m. PST, as stated in Sections 4 and 7 of the RFQ.

3. Who will evaluate the RFQ applications?

Answer: The LA CoC will not disclose the identities of individual application reviewers as part of the open procurement process in order to protect its integrity. Applications will be reviewed by a panel of subject matter experts relevant to the applicable Lead Entity role. Reviewers must complete confidentiality and conflict-of-interest screening in advance as well as undergo comprehensive training.

4. Will the LA CoC provide the names or contact information of prospective applicants to firms interested in serving as subcontractors or partners, or otherwise facilitate introductions?

Answer: No. The LA CoC will not identify prospective applicants, provide an applicant contact list, facilitate introductions, or endorse prospective subcontractors or partners during the active procurement process. Each Applicant is responsible for developing its proposed team and identifying all subcontractors and formal partners in its Application. To ensure impartiality, the LA CoC cannot share with any entities that submitted an Intent to Apply the names and contact information of any firms or organizations that contacted the CoC expressing an interest in partnering with a Lead Applicant.



5. How may an outside organization seek consideration for a Lead Entity role, and which LA CoC body makes the selection?

Answer: An organization may seek consideration only through the process established in the RFQ, including timely submission of the Mandatory Intent to Apply and Full Application and participation in an interview, if deemed eligible and invited. There is no alternate application, appointment, or presentation process. Under Section 9.4, the LA CoC Board retains final approval authority for the HMIS Lead candidate. For the Collaborative Applicant, CES Management Entity, and PIT Count Administrator roles, the Board assesses candidates and proposes candidates to the CoC General Membership, which makes the designation, subject to HUD and court review and any applicable requirements.

6. May a prospective applicant meet separately with LA CoC or LAHSA officials, or present its proposed model outside the RFQ process?

Answer: No. No separate meeting or presentation will be used to evaluate a prospective applicant outside the RFQ process. To preserve a fair and consistent process, substantive questions must be submitted through the official RFQ questions process, and proposed approaches must be presented in the required Application materials and, if applicable, during the interview. Note that the window for submitting questions closed at 11:59 PM PST on September 17, 2026.

7. Does an email expressing an intent to apply satisfy the Mandatory Intent to Apply requirement?

Answer: Section 7 of the RFQ requires eligible and interested entities must complete and submit the Mandatory Intent to Apply form, which was available on the LA CoC website. The Mandatory Intent to Apply was required to be submitted via email by the applicable deadline identified in the RFQ Timeline. An expression of interest in any form other than the Mandatory Intent to Apply will not be considered as an eligible Intent to Apply submission.

8. Will you clarify if my Intent to Apply was received and sufficient?

Answer: No. As stated in Section 7 of the RFQ, the LA CoC will not notify interested entities regarding the timeliness or eligibility of their submission at this juncture in the RFQ process.

9. May the minimum qualification requiring five years of experience administering at least \$5 million per year in State or federal funding and/or annual organizational budgets be satisfied through a fiscal partner rather than by the proposed Lead Entity?

Answer: No. The minimum organizational qualifications in Section 5.2 apply to the Applicant that would serve as the designated Lead Entity. Experience and capacity provided by a subcontractor or formal partner may support the Applicant's proposed qualifications and staffing model, but they do not substitute for the Lead Entity's responsibility to satisfy the minimum qualifications. The RFQ permits partnerships, but only one entity may serve as the designated Lead for each role.

10. Are there word limits for responses or tables where the Application materials do not state a word limit?

Answer: No. Wherever the RFQ or application do not specify a word limit, there is no limit. However, please be as succinct as possible in your responses. Longer responses will not necessarily score higher.



11. Will the LA CoC respond directly by email to substantive RFQ questions or applicant-specific requests for guidance?

Answer: No. Under Section 8, written responses to substantive RFQ questions will be posted on www.losangelescoc.org and will not be provided directly by email. The limited exception is for Applicant-specific technical issues that are not relevant to all Applicants, such as problems accessing files or submitting an Application. Any future applicant-specific requests for other types of guidance cannot be responded to as the question period expired on 11:59 PM PST on Thursday, September 17, 2026.

12. Which body has legal and administrative authority to designate, review, or replace the Collaborative Applicant for the Los Angeles CoC?

Answer: Federal regulations define the Collaborative Applicant as an eligible entity designated by the CoC. Under the LA CoC Governance Charter and Section 9.4 of the RFQ, the LA CoC Board assesses Collaborative Applicant candidates and proposes a candidate to the CoC General Membership, which will designate the Collaborative Applicant. Please note that the selection process currently under way is being conducted pursuant to a federal court order in the matter, *LAHSA v. Trump*, and the Court may institute additional requirements for the selection of the Collaborative Applicant, including review by HUD and the U.S. District Court. Any replacement would follow the applicable CoC governance process and remain subject to HUD requirements and any applicable court orders.

13. What qualifications, organizational capacity, governance standards, and federal requirements must be satisfied?

Answer: The Applicant must satisfy all eligibility, minimum qualification, and role-specific requirements in Sections 5 and 6 of the RFQ. These include:

- Qualifying as an eligible applicant under applicable federal statutes and regulatory requirements;
- Being legally established and authorized to conduct business in Los Angeles County;
- Possessing sufficient organizational authority, financial capacity, staffing, and operating systems;
- Demonstrating relevant experience administering complex homelessness, housing, human-services, federal-grant, or comparable public-sector functions;
- Having at least five years of experience administering at least \$5 million annually in State or federal funding and/or organizational budget of at least \$5 million;
- Demonstrating capacity to serve the full LA CoC geography and stakeholder network;
- Meeting applicable governance, privacy, security, nondiscrimination, audit, records, reporting, and conflict-of-interest requirements;
- Providing qualified executive oversight and dedicated day-to-day management; and
- Demonstrating the ability to perform the Collaborative Applicant responsibilities described in the RFQ.

The Applicant must also qualify as an eligible CoC Program applicant. For-profit entities are not eligible to serve as the Collaborative Applicant (24 CFR § 578.15) or CES Management Entity.



14. Is the Collaborative Applicant Role selected through Board action, procurement, application, election, appointment, agreement, or another formal process?

Answer: Under the LA CoC Governance Charter and Section 9.4 of the RFQ, the LA CoC Board assesses Collaborative Applicant candidates and proposes a candidate to the CoC General Membership, which has the authority to designate the Collaborative Applicant. The selection process currently under way is being conducted pursuant to a federal court order in the matter, *LAHSA v. Trump*, and the Court may consider additional requirements for the selection of the Collaborative Applicant, including review by HUD and the U.S. District Court. In order to respond to the Court's order, the LA CoC Board has chosen to use an RFQ process in order to fairly and impartially solicit prospective Collaborative Applicant candidates.

15. When is the designation next subject to review?

Answer: We are interpreting this question to pertain to the judicial review process. If so, the Court directed the LA CoC to file a written report by October 13, 2026, summarizing its evaluation of all entities that applied. Following the LA CoC's report, HUD will submit its response within seven days regarding the LA CoC's evaluation of the applicant pool.

16. Can an outside organization formally seek consideration for the role?

Answer: Please see questions #12 and #13 for guidance on entities who are eligible for this RFQ.